CHURN IS DEAD

The Work Ownership Decision Matrix

Give recurring customer work to the person who can make the binding decision.

Use this matrix for one recurring task that currently lands with a senior CSM. Separate the customer consequence from the binding decision, identify the person with authority, then choose whether CS should own, prepare, coordinate, or remove the work.

Use: Do not total the rows into an ownership score. Record the decision, the rightful owner, the CSM contribution, and the stop rule.

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SECTION 1

Work and Customer Consequence

A task can matter deeply to the customer without belonging to the CSM.

Record	Question	Evidence
Recurring work	What happens, how often, and what triggers it?	Workflow or recent example
Customer consequence	What changes for the customer if it is late, wrong, or absent?	Observed consequence
Required output	Is the output a decision, execution, evidence package, update, or handoff?	Named deliverable
End condition	What observable state means this occurrence is complete?	Completion test

Review This Section

Decision prompt: What customer decision or consequence makes this work necessary?

Record: _____

SECTION 2

Authority and Capability Test

> Accountability without authority turns the CSM into a permanent escalation layer.

Test	Record this	Ownership signal
Binding decision	The exact choice that must be made	Who has final authority?
Resources	Budget, backlog, technical access, policy, or people required	Who controls them?
Capability	Expert judgement or execution skill the work requires	Which function holds it?
Current mismatch	What is CS held responsible for but unable to decide?	Evidence of the gap

Review This Section

Decision prompt: Who can make the binding trade-off and control the resources required?

Record: _____

SECTION 3

Ownership Mode Decision

A useful boundary specifies what CS still contributes instead of merely rejecting the work.

Mode	Use when	Record the boundary
Own	CS can decide and the work requires customer judgement	Authority and outcome
Prepare	Another DRI decides; CS supplies evidence and recommendation	Input and answer date
Coordinate	A handoff needs temporary customer continuity	Owner, cadence, and stop rule
Remove	Work is repeated, automatable, duplicated, or non-durable	Process change and owner

Review This Section

Decision prompt: Should CS own, prepare, coordinate, or remove this work?

Record: _____

SECTION 4

Handoff and Review Record

Reassignment fails when the new owner, decision date, and customer communication remain implicit.

Record	Required detail	Owner/date
Rightful DRI	One person with final authority for the decision or execution	Name and function
CS contribution	Evidence, recommendation, context, or customer communication	Deliverable and date
Stop rule	Event after which CS coordination ends	Observable state
Review	Did the decision move and did the task return to CS?	Review date and action

Review This Section

Decision prompt: What changes at the next occurrence, and how will the team know the boundary held?

Record: _____

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Ownership Change Record

Record	Complete this
Recurring work and chosen mode	_____
Rightful DRI and authority	_____
CS contribution and due date	_____
Stop rule and review date	_____

CS mode	Use when	Required record
Own	CS has the authority, capability, and customer obligation to make the decision	Outcome, decision boundary, and review date
Prepare	Another function decides and CS contributes customer evidence or a recommendation	DRI, input package, and decision date
Coordinate	CS must preserve customer continuity across a time-bounded handoff	Operational owner, update cadence, escalation path, and stop rule
Remove	The work is repetitive, automatable, duplicative, or creates no durable improvement	Automation, process change, or activity to stop

What to do next: Choose one task that recurs at least monthly. Complete the four sections, name the rightful DRI, and change the next occurrence before redesigning the entire role.